why he was naturally suited to franchise cricket. Everything's new, fresh and exciting for three weeks, and then he breezes off, into another town, to do it all again with another team. Spending ten months of the year with him is an entirely different proposition.

The warning signs were obvious. Kevin felt misunderstood, rightly or wrongly, for long periods in his career and preferred love to be unconditional. Lines of communication had to be clear and unambiguous. As a captain, I tried to treat people individually, and sensitively, within certain boundaries.

He was always going to be on his best behaviour in India, which was a phenomenal tour on which to bed in as captain. It is a personal challenge, as much as anything, since it is a tour when you spend too much time in your room. Security had increased following the Mumbai bombings, so wandering through crowds excited by their proximity to an international cricketer was impractical.

I was brought up to treat people fairly and with respect. The adulation you receive as an England player in India is difficult to justify, but logical, if you see what I mean. Cricket assumes exaggerated importance because it enhances everyday life. It costs nothing to be civil. A smile or a quick conversation with the lift attendant or the breakfast waiter can make his day.

If India's people are captivating, its poverty is overwhelming. Sometimes you get morally confused by it. One of my great strengths as a cricketer is compartmentalizing my game, not being dull or dense, but refusing to overanalyse things. Yet it is impossible to sit in a grand, spacious hotel and eat fine food with the knowledge that on the other side of the hedge children are washing in polluted ponds.

It is difficult to get your head around such extremes. You are never immune to the suffering of a fellow human being; I've found that in India emotion seeps out in surprising ways. When we were in Ahmedabad, playing our third and final warm-up match before the first Test was staged there, I watched the box set of *The Pacific* , an American mini-series that followed a band of soldiers through Second World War battles in the Pacific rim.

The storylines were compelling and the characters believable. I'm not usually one to cry at fictional TV but was tearful immediately after the final episode, in which two main characters, turned into cynics stripped of